

Buddy Guide

Progressive hints, not answers

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
Document reference	Facilitator pack
Classification	FACILITATOR ONLY - do not distribute
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Your job is to ask better questions, not to solve the case. Never name 'efficiency versus ethics' or 'elitist outside-in' to participants. Use the three-level hint ladder. Only move to the next level if the team is genuinely stuck.

The hint ladder

Problem framing

1. Level 1: What exactly is the Board asking you to decide?
2. Level 2: Is your problem statement about programmes, geography, funding, or all three?
3. Level 3: Ask which voices in the data room pull hardest in opposite directions.

Asking for evidence

1. Level 1: What would you need to know to choose between your options?
2. Level 2: Have you filed an Analysis Request, or are you guessing from the annual report?
3. Level 3: Ask A to turn one hypothesis into R-0x before inventing a number.

Drivers of placement / attendance

1. Level 1: Staff and young people talk about what helps someone get a job - have you tested any of that?
2. Level 2: Would attendance or programme design change your recommendation if the data disagreed?
3. Level 3: Nudge A toward a request on placement drivers; then coach B on joining tables without giving the steps.

Mentoring / completion / volunteers

1. Level 1: Transcripts mention mentoring and drop-out - is that a claim or an evidence gap?
2. Level 2: What would you ask B if mentoring intensity mattered for your option?
3. Level 3: If B is stuck: which tables mention mentors or completion? What would you exclude before averaging?

Placement rate

1. Level 1: What does 'placed' actually mean here?
2. Level 2: Whose definition are you using - D-01's or ST-02's?
3. Level 3: Have B compute both the broad and the formal rate and return them via a Findings Memo.

Recommendations

1. Level 1: What is the evidence for that claim?
2. Level 2: Which transcript or Findings Memo backs this up?
3. Level 3: Ask them to map every recommendation to a source in the validation protocol, including R-/FM-IDs.

Costs of the choice

1. Level 1: Who gains under your recommendation?
2. Level 2: Who waits longer, or is deprioritised, if you choose this path?
3. Level 3: Point them to the trade-off reflection without naming the dilemma for them.

Coaching B on deep-dive requests (staff only)

Participant packs no longer prescribe DB-3/DB-4 methods. When B receives a request about attendance, placement drivers, mentoring or completion:

1. Ask them to restate A's decision question in one sentence.
2. Ask which tables in the data dictionary look relevant - do not name the join path first.
3. If still stuck, Level 2: 'How would you get one attendance rate per young person?' or 'What would you do with hours logged against inactive mentors?'
4. Level 3 (last resort): point them to Facilitators/05_Data_Task_Solutions for method hints - do not read the expected findings aloud.
5. Always push: association is not causation; name confounders in the Findings Memo.

Check-in schedule

Fridays of Weeks 1-7. Fifteen minutes. Review Request Log health, Findings Memo quality, and whether claims are cited. Do not review answers for correctness. Do not give A the dataset. From Week 3, check whether A has asked at least one driver/mentoring question if their options depend on it.

Common mistakes to expect

- Accepting the 71% placement rate at face value.
- A reverse-engineering strategy from D-01 without querying B.
- B sharing the raw workbook or answering questions A never asked.
- A never asking about attendance, mentoring or completion despite transcript clues.
- Recommending national scale without fixing Dong Nai.
- Treating the board email (D-08) as fact.
- Claiming attendance causes placement.
- Empty trade-off reflection; no named cost of the preferred path.